



History of Jenkins

Introduction

Jenkins is a widely used **automation server** that helps in **Continuous Integration (CI) and Continuous Deployment (CD)**.

- Where did Jenkins originate from?
- How has Jenkins evolved over time?
- What makes Jenkins one of the most popular DevOps tools today?

This guide provides a **detailed history of Jenkins and its development over time**.

Section 1: Learn

How Did Jenkins Start?

- Jenkins was originally developed as **Hudson** in 2004 by **Kohsuke Kawaguchi**, a Java developer at **Sun Microsystems**.
- Kohsuke wanted a tool to **automate testing and deployment** so that developers could detect errors early.
- He created Hudson as an **open-source** CI tool for **Java projects**.

Why Did Hudson Become Jenkins?

- In 2010, Oracle acquired Sun Microsystems and took control of **Hudson**.
- The **open-source community disagreed** with Oracle's decisions regarding Hudson.
- In 2011, the community **forked Hudson** and renamed it **Jenkins**, continuing its development independently.



- Over time, **Jenkins became more popular than Hudson**, leading to Hudson's discontinuation in 2013.

Evolution of Jenkins

Year	Event
2004	Kohsuke Kawaguchi creates Hudson at Sun Microsystems
2010	Oracle acquires Sun and takes control of Hudson
2011	Hudson is forked, and Jenkins is born
2013	Jenkins surpasses Hudson in popularity
2015	Jenkins 2.0 introduces Pipeline as Code
2020	Jenkins improves Docker and Kubernetes integration
2022	Jenkins remains the leading CI/CD automation tool

Why Did Jenkins Become Popular?

- **Open-source and free to use** – Anyone can contribute to development.
- **Extensive Plugin Ecosystem** – Supports **1,500+ plugins** for integrations.
- **Language-Agnostic** – Supports builds in **Java, Python, Node.js**, and more.



- **Easy Integration** – Works with **Git, Docker, Kubernetes, AWS, and Terraform.**

An Interesting Anecdote

In 2011, many developers feared Jenkins wouldn't survive after **Hudson's fork**. However, by 2013, **Jenkins had grown into the world's most popular CI/CD tool**, proving that community-driven development can lead to incredible success!

Section 2: Practice

1. Checking the Jenkins Version Installed

To verify the Jenkins version, run:

```
jenkins --version
```

Or check the version in the UI:

1. Open **Jenkins Dashboard** → Click **Manage Jenkins**.
 2. Scroll down to **System Information** → Find **Jenkins Version**.
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2. Installing an Older Version of Jenkins

To install **Jenkins 2.263.4 LTS (Older Version)** on Ubuntu:

```
wget https://pkg.jenkins.io/debian-stable/binary/jenkins_2.263.4_all.deb  
sudo dpkg -i jenkins_2.263.4_all.deb
```

To install the latest version:



```
sudo apt update  
sudo apt install jenkins -y
```

Why is this useful?

- Helps in **troubleshooting** compatibility issues when working with older Jenkins environments.
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3. Viewing Jenkins Changelog

To see the history of Jenkins updates, visit:

[Jenkins Release Notes](#)

Why is this important?

- Helps **track new features and security updates** in Jenkins.
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Section 3: Know More

Frequently Asked Questions

1. **Who created Jenkins?**
 - Kohsuke Kawaguchi at Sun Microsystems in 2004.
2. **Why did Hudson become Jenkins?**
 - Due to a **dispute between the open-source community and Oracle**, Hudson was forked as **Jenkins** in 2011.
3. **When was Jenkins 2.0 released?**
 - Jenkins 2.0 was released in **2016**, introducing **Pipeline as Code**.
4. **What are some alternatives to Jenkins?**
 - **GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, CircleCI, and Travis CI**.
5. **Where can I learn more about Jenkins history?**
 - Visit [Jenkins Official Website](#).



Conclusion

Jenkins has evolved from a **simple Java-based CI tool** to a **powerful DevOps automation platform**.

By understanding **its history, installation methods, and updates**, you can **better appreciate its role in modern software development!**